Level 2 Adult ESL Curriculum: Semester Plan and Lessons 1–4 (Version 4.1)

Working title: *Talk Together: Level 2* (placeholder; run a trademark search before adopting any name, see Section 7)

Version: 4.1, public edition (revised October 15, 2026: teacher instructions need no Spanish)

Audience: Program coordinators and volunteer teachers

Companion files: `Level2_Curriculum_v4_1_public.md` (same content), `Level2_Curriculum_v4_1_public.pdf` (print version), `audio/` (listening MP3s for Lessons 1–4), `images/` (52 vocabulary pictures + `images/CREDITS.md`)

> **Content policy:** This curriculum is fully secular. It contains no religious, apologetics, or faith-based content, and none should be added. Topics are practical daily life, work, family, health, shopping, and community services.

> **Independence notice:** Independent project, not affiliated with or endorsed by Intercambio Uniting Communities.

How this document is organized

Part	What's inside	Who uses it
A. Program Guide	What changed, the semester plan, the weekly routine, scope and sequence, exam and graduation weeks	Coordinators, all teachers
B. Teacher Guide	Lessons 1–4: at a glance, clock-time plan, step-by-step boxes, listening scripts, answer keys	Volunteer teachers
C. Student Workbook	Lessons 1–4: New Words, Listening, Grammar, Homework. **Print this part for learners**	Learners
D. Reference	Audio, copyright and licensing, printing, website, open questions, sources	Coordinators

PART A

Program Guide

The semester, the weekly routine, and the course plan

0. What Changed in Version 4.1

Teachers do not need to speak Spanish. All teachers are assumed to be fluent English speakers who may speak no Spanish. Teacher instructions now only ask teachers to work in English. The Spanish notes stay on the student pages for learners to read on their own.

Where	Version 4	Version 4.1
Lesson 1, Step 2 (Orientation)	Language rule: "English first. Spanish for 10 seconds to help, then back to English."	Rule in English only: "English in class. If you're stuck, a classmate can help you for a few seconds. Then back to English." The teacher does not need to understand or use the other language
Teacher Guide intro	Mentioned the Spanish note only	New box: **"You don't need to speak Spanish"**, with what to do when a learner is stuck or asks something in Spanish
Lesson 1 and Lesson 4 teacher notes	"Spanish speakers: watch for…"	The typical mistake is explained in English, and the teacher **points learners to the Spanish note** on the Grammar page
Section 3.3 grammar order	"(L1)", "(L2)"…	"(Lesson 1)", "(Lesson 2)"… so "L1" is not confused with "first language"
Section 0.3 (Version 2 changes)	"Spanish support" row	Clarified that learners read the Spanish notes themselves

0.1 What Changed in Version 4

Topic	Version 3	Version 4
Organization	Teacher plan and student pages mixed together inside each lesson	**Four parts:** A. Program Guide, B. Teacher Guide, C. Student Workbook, D. Reference. The Student Workbook can be printed on its own
Layout	Dense pages, small type	**More white space**, larger type on student pages (13 pt), clear headers, page breaks between lessons and between sections
Teacher steps	Long paragraphs	**One activity per box**: grouping, what to do, what to say, and "If behind" as short lines
Student pages	Everything on 2 pages	**One topic per page**: New Words · Listening · Grammar · Homework (with writing lines)
Grammar	Q&A with tables	**Two-sided grammar boxes** (QUESTION on the left, ANSWER on the right) with substitution columns, then the short Q&A, common mistakes, and the Spanish note
Clock tables	Time column wrapped ("6:00–" / "6:10")	Wider fixed time column
Pictures and audio	—	Unchanged from Version 3

0.2 What Changed in Version 3

Topic	Version 2	Version 3 (this document)
Vocabulary	Word lists only	**A picture for every key word in Lessons 1–4** (52 pictures) on a "New Words" page at the top of each Student Page. ★ marks the 8 most important words. Pictures are Twemoji (CC BY 4.0, with attribution) plus original drawings. See `images/CREDITS.md` and Section 12
Grammar	Rule boxes and tables	**Grammar Q&A**: every grammar section is a set of questions learners actually ask (*Q: When do I add -s? A:* …), with the same tables, examples, common-mistake tables, Spanish notes, and tips
Core time	6:00–6:45 + 7:00–7:20, steps of 5–7 min	**6:00–6:45 + 7:00–7:15**, fewer and longer steps (8–15 min)
Opening + homework	Two separate 5-minute steps	**One 10-minute block** with the same partner; the teacher corrects only 2 items
Pronunciation	A 5-minute core step after the break	A 1–2 minute **"Say it"** repeat inside Listening; the full pronunciation activity moves to "If time"
Pair practice	A separate 6-minute step	A **short** pair check inside the Grammar block (last 3–5 min); the long version moves to "If time"
7:15–7:30	Exit ticket + 10-min extension	**"If time" menu** in priority order: ① pronunciation ② pair game ③ extension
Running behind	"Short-night rules" only	**"If running behind" column** in every lesson plan, plus a priority list (Section 2.1)

0.3 What Changed in Version 2

Topic	Version 1	Version 2
Course length	32 lessons, 8 units	**16-week semester, 1 class per week, 13 new-content lessons** + midterm (Week 8) + final (Week 15) + graduation (Week 16)
Class time	90 minutes	**6:00–6:45 PM, 15-minute break, 7:00–7:20 PM core**, optional extension until 7:30
Group size	6–15	**About 15 at the start, dropping to 7–8.** Every activity has a "15 learners / 7–8 learners" version
Spanish support	Teacher notes only	**Short Spanish notes in the student pages** (learners read them on their own; teachers need no Spanish) + rules for all learners + tips for speakers of other languages
Listening	Teacher read-aloud dialogue	**A listening section in every lesson**: an audio clip + check/circle/fill-in tasks. **MP3s made for Lessons 1–4** with a free, Apache-licensed AI voice
Homework	None	**Short homework every lesson**, checked at 6:05 the next week
Opening	Warm-up game	**5-minute partner question** based on the previous lesson (works for late arrivals)
Review lessons	Every 4th lesson	Removed; review happens in homework checks, warm-ups, Week 8, and Week 15
New sections	—	Copyright and licensing (Sec. 7), TTS audio (Sec. 6), workbook printing (Sec. 8), website hosting (Sec. 9)

1. The Semester at a Glance

Week	Class	Content	Notes
1	**Lesson 1:** Nice to Meet You	*be* vs. *do* questions	Includes orientation and baseline snapshot
2	**Lesson 2:** A Day in My Life	Simple present (*he/she* + *-s*), frequency words	
3	**Lesson 3:** Free Time	*like/love/hate* + *-ing*; *me too / me neither*	
4	**Lesson 4:** Right Now	Present continuous; "now" vs. "every day"	
5	**Lesson 5:** Last Weekend	Past of *be*; simple past (regular *-ed*)	
6	**Lesson 6:** My Story	Irregular past; *Did you…?*; *ago*	
7	**Lesson 7:** Getting Around	Comparatives; *How long does it take?*	
8	**MIDTERM**	Review stations + exam (Lessons 1–7)	No new content
9	**Lesson 8:** The Best Place in Town	Superlatives; recommending places	
10	**Lesson 9:** Food and Shopping	Count/noncount; *some/any*; *How much/many*; *I'd like*	
11	**Lesson 10:** Health	*I have a cold*; *My ___ hurts*; *should / shouldn't*	
12	**Lesson 11:** Making Plans	*be going to*; invitations; present continuous for plans	
13	**Lesson 12:** Getting Things Done	*have to / need to*; *Can/Could you…?*; phone calls about services	
14	**Lesson 13:** Then, Now, and Next	Past/present/future together; prepare graduation talk	
15	**FINAL**	Review stations + exam (all lessons)	No new content
16	**GRADUATION**	Certificates, 1-minute talks, celebration	No new content

2. The Class Routine (Same Every Week)

2.1 Clock-time template

*The **core** runs **6:00–6:45** and **7:00–7:15** (60 minutes). It has six steps, each with room to breathe. **7:15–7:30 is optional** ("If time"). Week 1 uses a modified version (see Lesson 1).*

Clock time	Step	Minutes	What happens	Status
6:00–6:10	1. **Opening Talk + Homework Check**	10	Same partner for both. *First ~5 min:* a question about last week's lesson (late arrivals join a pair). *Next ~5 min:* compare homework. The teacher corrects **only 2** items on the board.	Core
6:10–6:18	2. **New Words**	8	Picture page: point, say, repeat; quick pair game	Core
6:18–6:30	3. **Listening + "Say it"**	12	Before you listen → Task A → Task B → Task C (grammar fill-in) → 1–2 min repeating 2 lines from the audio	Core
6:30–6:45	4. **Grammar Q&A + quick pair check**	15	Learners read the Q's; class answers; examples, common mistakes, check questions; then 3–5 min of pair practice	Core
6:45–7:00	**BREAK**	15		
7:00–7:10	5. **Talk Time**	10	The main speaking activity of the night	Core
7:10–7:15	6. **Exit Ticket + Homework**	5	One sentence on a slip; explain the homework and do item 1 together	**Never skip**
7:15–7:30	**If time** (pick in order)	0–15	① Pronunciation activity (5) ② Pair practice game, long version (5–10) ③ Extension / second Talk Time round (10)	Optional

If you're running behind, skip in this order: (1) everything in "If time"; (2) the third play of the audio, so do Task C together with the teacher reading the lines; (3) the pair check at the end of Grammar, which becomes part of the homework; (4) teach only the ★ words (the others stay on the page for home study); (5) the second half of Talk Time, so do one round only. **Never skip:** the Listening tasks, the Grammar Q&A mistakes table, and the Exit Ticket + Homework.

If you're ahead of time: go to the "If time" menu at 7:15, or let Talk Time run 5 minutes longer and switch partners once more.

Late-arrival rules: Step 1 is designed for people walking in late. A late learner joins any pair (making a group of 3) and starts talking right away. Keep 3 extra copies of every handout by the door.

Why the change from Version 2: Version 2 had 9 steps of 5–7 minutes each, so every transition (moving

chairs, handing out paper, late arrivals) cost time the plan didn't have. Version 3 has 6 core steps with built-in slack, and everything else is clearly optional.

2.2 Adapting to attendance (15 → 7–8 learners)

Situation	15 learners	7–8 learners	5 or fewer
Pairs	7 pairs + 1 group of 3	3–4 pairs	Pairs; the teacher joins only if one person is left
Small groups	3–4 groups of 4–5	2 groups of 3–4	One group
Circles (inside–outside)	Two circles of 7–8, or one big circle	One circle	Use "rotate seats" instead
Mingles	Each learner talks to 5–6 people	Each learner talks to everyone	Turn the mingle into a table interview
Printing	Print for the **number expected**, plus 3 spares		

Why attendance drops, and what helps: adults miss class because of work and family. The homework check and opening question give returning learners a quick way back in. Each lesson's handout stands alone, so a learner who missed a week can still follow.

2.3 Assessment and progress (semester version)

Tool	When	What	Who / how long
Baseline snapshot	Weeks 1–3	Same 6 speaking prompts every time (name, from, live, work, routine, free time)	Teacher or a second volunteer, 2 minutes per learner, about 5 learners per week during Talk Time
Can-do self-check	Week 1, Week 8, Week 15	"I can..." list with 😀 🙂 😐	Learner, 5 minutes
Exit ticket	Every lesson	One sentence or question with today's grammar	Learner; teacher reads it after class
Homework	Every lesson	Short written or speaking task	Pairs check in the 6:00–6:10 opening block
Midterm	Week 8	Listening (audio), grammar (15 items), speaking (pair task + rubric) on Lessons 1–7	See Section 4.1
Final	Week 15	Same format, all lessons, focus on 8–13; speaking uses the baseline prompts to show growth	See Section 4.1
Speaking rubric	Midterm, final, and some Talk Times	Communication / target grammar / pronunciation and fluency, each scored 1–3	Teacher

Speaking rubric (same as v1):

Score	Communication	Target grammar	Pronunciation and fluency
3	Completes the task; asks and answers follow-up questions	Uses the target form correctly most of the time	Easy to understand; few long pauses
2	Completes most of the task with some help	Uses the form, with errors that don't block meaning	Mostly understandable; some pauses
1	Needs a lot of help; very short answers	Rarely uses the form, or errors block meaning	Hard to understand without effort

Proposed graduation standard (confirm): attend at least 9 of the 13 lessons (plus the exams) and complete the final. "Ready for Level 3" = 2 or higher in all rubric areas on the final, plus 🙂 or 😀 on at least 80% of the can-do list. Learners who are not ready still graduate from the course and are encouraged to repeat Level 2.

3. Scope and Sequence: 13 Lessons

3.1 Lesson list

# (Week)	Title	Grammar	Real-life function	Listening (audio)	Pronunciation
1 (W 1)	Nice to Meet You	*be* vs. *do/does* questions; short answers	Meet a new classmate or neighbor	Two neighbors meet at a community center	Rising ↗ / falling ↘ question intonation
2 (W 2)	A Day in My Life	Simple present; *he/she* + *-s*; *doesn't*; frequency words	Describe routines; compare weeks	Coworkers talk about a long day	*-s* endings /s/ /z/ /ɪz/
3 (W 3)	Free Time	*love/like/don't mind/hate* + noun or *-ing*; *me too / me neither*	Break-room small talk	Coworkers talk about weekends	/ŋ/ in *-ing*; stress for feeling
4 (W 4)	Right Now	Present continuous (*am/is/are* + *-ing*); now vs. every day	Phone call: "What are you doing?"; telling time (review)	A phone call while waiting for the bus	Contractions *I'm*, *she's*, *they're*
5 (W 5)	Last Weekend	*was/were*; simple past regular verbs	Talk about the weekend; ask *How was…?*	Friends talk about their weekend	*-ed* endings /t/ /d/ /ɪd/
6 (W 6)	My Story	Common irregular past verbs; *Did you…?*; negatives; *ago*	Tell a short life story (moving, first job, first days here)	A learner tells how she started a new life in a new city	*Did you* → "didja" (recognize)
7 (W 7)	Getting Around	Comparatives (*-er / more / better*); *How long does it take?*; *by bus / on foot*	Compare commutes and ways to travel	Two people compare bus vs. car	*-er* /ər/; word stress
— (W 8)	**Midterm**	Review of Lessons 1–7		Midterm listening clip	
8 (W 9)	The Best Place in Town	Superlatives (*the -est / the most / the best*); *there is / there are* (review)	Recommend a store, park, or clinic	Neighbors recommend places	*th* /ð/ in *the*, *there*
9 (W 10)	Food and Shopping	Count/noncount; *some/any*; *How much/How many*; *I'd like / Can I have…?*	Order food; make a shopping list	Ordering at a restaurant	/ɪ/ vs. /i/ (*chip/cheap*)
10 (W 11)	Health	*I have a…*; *My ___ hurts*; *should / shouldn't*	Describe symptoms; make an appointment by phone	Calling a clinic	/ʃ/ vs. /tʃ/ (*shoe/chew*); silent *l* in *should*
11 (W 12)	Making Plans	*be going to*; present continuous for arrangements; invitations	Invite, accept, decline politely	Friends make weekend plans	*going to* → "gonna" (recognize)

# (Week)	Title	Grammar	Real-life function	Listening (audio)	Pronunciation
12 (W 13)	Getting Things Done	*have to / need to*; *Can/Could you…?*	Call about a bill; mail a package; leave a voicemail	A customer service call	*have to* → "hafta"; polite intonation
13 (W 14)	Then, Now, and Next	Past + present + future in one story	Prepare and practice a 1-minute graduation talk	A former learner's short talk	Sentence stress and linking

3.2 What we dropped or moved (to fit 13 lessons)

Topic (v1)	Decision	Why
Describing people (*What's he like? / What does he look like?*)	Optional bonus worksheet; may belong in Level 1 or 3	Lower priority than survival functions; confirm with Level 1 content
Directions and prepositions of movement	Optional "If time" activity in Lesson 7	Lesson 7 already contains comparatives and travel time
a few / a little	Light mention in Lesson 9 only	Keeps Lesson 9 manageable
can / can't for ability	Dropped (probably Level 1)	Confirm with Level 1
will for offers; object pronouns	Moved to Level 3	Not essential for this level's goals
Feelings about moving	Folded into Lesson 6 (*I felt nervous / happy*)	Fits the life-story topic
Holidays and celebrations	Optional in Lesson 6 (learners choose what to share)	Kept secular and optional
Telling time as a full lesson	Reviewed inside Lesson 4	Most learners know numbers; practice the language in context instead

3.3 Grammar in teaching order

1. *be* vs. *do* questions (Lesson 1) → 2. simple present + *-s* (Lesson 2) → 3. frequency adverbs (Lesson 2) → 4. *like* + *-ing*, *me too/neither* (Lesson 3) → 5. present continuous (Lesson 4) → 6. simple present vs. continuous (Lesson 4) → 7. *was/were* (Lesson 5) → 8. regular past (Lesson 5) → 9. irregular past + *did* (Lesson 6) → 10. comparatives (Lesson 7) → **midterm** → 11. superlatives (Lesson 8) → 12. count/noncount, *some/any*, *how much/many* (Lesson 9) → 13. *I'd like / Can I have* (Lesson 9) → 14. *should* (Lesson 10) → 15. *be going to* (Lesson 11) → 16. present continuous for plans (Lesson 11) → 17. *have to / need to*, *Can/Could you* (Lesson 12) → 18. tense review (Lesson 13) → **final**.

Spiral recycling: every Opening Talk reuses last week's grammar. The homework always mixes in one older point. The midterm and final review stations revisit everything.

4. Exam and Graduation Weeks

4.1 Midterm (Week 8) and Final (Week 15)

Clock time	What	Notes
6:00–6:05	Opening Talk (review question)	
6:05–6:45	**Review stations** (4 tables, 10 minutes each): ① Grammar Auction, ② Listening replay (previous lesson audio on a phone or speaker), ③ Question cards (speaking), ④ Pronunciation bingo	**Speaking test during the stations:** the teacher (or a second volunteer) calls pairs to a quiet corner for a 3-minute task scored with the rubric. With 15 learners, about 8 pairs × 3 minutes = 24 minutes; with 7–8 learners, about 12 minutes.
6:45–7:00	Break	
7:00–7:20	**Written test:** listening (play the audio again if needed; check/circle/fill-in, 8 items) + grammar (15 items)	Use the same task types learners know from class. **No surprises.**
7:20–7:30	Can-do self-check; learners set one goal	

> **Exam-week timing (unchanged from Version 2):** exam nights use their own plan above, not the lesson template. The written test may run to 7:20 so slower readers are not rushed; the 7:20–7:30 self-check can go home as a take-home sheet if time is short.

Confirm whether the program needs grades. We recommend a simple scale: "Meets / Almost / Not yet."

4.2 Graduation (Week 16)

- No new content. Each learner gives their **1-minute talk** prepared in Lesson 13 (or reads 2–3 sentences).
- Certificates of completion. Optional potluck: ask about allergies, and don't require anyone to bring food.
- Hand out a "Keep practicing" sheet with the website and QR codes for all audio.

PART B

Teacher Guide

Lessons 1–4

At a glance · Clock-time plan · Step by step · Script and answer key

5. Teacher Guide: How to Use the Lesson Plans

How to read these plans: Each lesson has (A) a **Teacher Plan** with clock times, steps, the listening script, and answer keys, and (B) a **Student Page** to print. The student page has the listening tasks, grammar box, Spanish note (*Nota para hispanohablantes*, written for learners to read on their own; teachers don't need to read or explain it), tips for all learners, and the homework. Audio files are in `audio/` (L1_listening.mp3 … L4_listening.mp3). Each file plays the conversation **once**; play the audio again if needed. **No speaker or device?** Read the script aloud with a volunteer learner.

Grouping toolkit: *Pairs:* turn to a neighbor; with an odd number make one group of 3. *New partners:* matching cards, or line up by birthday month and "fold" the line. *Inside–outside circles:* inner circle faces out, outer circle faces in; the outer circle moves one person clockwise each round. *Instruction rule:* **Model it** (show with one learner), **check it** (ask "Do you write or speak?"), **then go** (start the timer).

You don't need to speak Spanish. Teach in English. The Spanish notes on the student pages are for learners to read on their own. They are not something you need to read, translate, or explain.

When a learner is stuck or asks something in Spanish: (1) show it: use the picture, a gesture, or the board; (2) give one more simple English example; (3) point to the Grammar Box or the Spanish note on their page; (4) ask a classmate to help for a few seconds, then continue in English. You don't need to understand what classmates say to each other.

Where are the student pages? In **Part C: Student Workbook**. Each lesson there has four pages: New Words, Listening, Grammar, Homework.

Lesson 1 · Nice to Meet You (Week 1)

At a glance

Objectives: learners can...

- ask and answer 8 or more personal-information questions
- choose between *be* and *do* questions
- introduce a partner using *he/she*

Materials

- name tags
- markers
- "How Our Class Works" sheet
- Student Page 1
- question-card envelopes (one per pair)
- "Find Someone Who" sheet
- baseline checklist
- phone + small speaker
- `L1_listening.mp3`
- **Prep time:** 30 min.

Key vocabulary (with pictures in the Student Workbook)

from, *live*, *work*, *job*, *neighborhood*, *married / single*, *kids*, *brother / sister*, *hometown*, *near*, *nice to meet you*, *What about you?*

Clock-time plan

Core = 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. Everything after 7:15 is optional ("If time").

Time	Step	Min	Grouping (15 / 7–8)	If running behind
6:00–6:10	Welcome + **Name Chain** (the Week 1 opening)	10	Two circles / one circle	Go around once only
6:10–6:15	**Orientation:** "How Our Class Works"	5	Whole class	Hand out the sheet; read the 3 key rules only
6:15–6:23	**New Words** (picture page)	8	Pairs	Teach the ★ words only
6:23–6:33	**Listening** (audio) + "Say it"	10	Individuals, then pairs check	Skip the third play; do Task C as a whole class
6:33–6:45	**Grammar Q&A:** *be* or *do*? + quick pair check	12	Whole class, then pairs	Skip the pair check; it becomes homework item 1
6:45–7:00	BREAK	15		
7:00–7:10	**Talk Time: Find Someone Who** + baseline snapshot	10	Talk to 6+ people / everyone	Learners talk to 4 people
7:10–7:15	**Exit Ticket + Homework**	5		**Never skip**
7:15–7:30	***If time*** (in this order): ① Pronunciation ↗/↘ (5) ② Question Scramble (5) ③ Interview and Introduce (10)	0–15		Optional

> **How to use this plan:** the **core** is 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. If you fall behind, use the right-hand column. Everything after 7:15 is optional.

Step by step

Step 1 · 6:00–6:10 · Welcome + Name Chain · 10 min

- **Grouping:** two circles (15 learners) / one circle (7–8 learners).
- **Model:** "I'm Ana. I like coffee."
- **Do:** each next person repeats the previous person, then adds their own: "She's Ana. She likes coffee. I'm Carlos. I like soccer."
- **Late arrivals:** join the circle.
- **If behind:** go around once only.

Step 2 · 6:10–6:15 · Orientation: "How Our Class Works" · 5 min

- **Grouping:** whole class.
- **Cover:** class times and the break; homework every week (short!), checked at the start of class.
- **Language rule:** "**English in class. If you're stuck, a classmate can help you for a few seconds. Then back to English.**" You don't need to understand what classmates say to each other. Just smile and say "Now in English, please."
- **Also say:** phones are OK for audio and dictionary. "You can tell the truth or make it up."
- **If behind:** hand out the sheet and read the 3 key rules only.

Step 3 · 6:15–6:23 · New Words · 8 min

- **Grouping:** pairs.
- **Do:** open the Student Workbook to the New Words page. Point to each picture, say the word; learners repeat twice.
- **Pairs:** A points to a picture, B says the word. Then switch.
- **Extra example:** show the ID card for a fictional person.
- **If behind:** teach only the ★ words.

Step 4 · 6:23–6:33 · Listening + "Say it" · 10 min

- **Grouping:** individuals, then pairs check.
- **Before you listen (1 min):** "Rosa and Sam meet. What questions do they ask?" Write 2–3 guesses.
- **Listen 1 → Task A** (true/false). **Listen 2 → Task B** (circle). **Listen 3 → Task C** (write *are / do*).
- **Pairs compare** after each task.
- **"Say it" (1–2 min):** pause after "Where are you from?" and "Where do you live?" The class repeats each line twice.
- **Bridge to grammar:** "When do we use *are*? When do we use *do*?"
- **If behind:** skip the third play; do Task C together (teacher reads the 4 lines).

Step 5 · 6:33–6:45 · Grammar: be or do? · 12 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then pairs.
- **Show:** the Grammar Box (question side / answer side).
- **Say:** "English questions need a **helper word at the front**. With *am/is/are*, move it to the front. With no *be*, **borrow *do* or *does***."
- **Q&A:** a learner reads a **Q**; the class guesses; read the **A**; write one example on the board.
- **Check questions:** "___ you like rice?" (*do*) • "___ you tired?" (*are*) • "Where ___ she work?" (*does*)
- **Pair check (last 3–4 min):** A builds a question from the box; B answers from the answer side.
- **If behind:** skip the pair check.

Break · 6:45–7:00 · 15 min

- Set up the "Find Someone Who" sheets during the break.

Step 6 · 7:00–7:10 · Talk Time: Find Someone Who · 10 min

- **Grouping:** mingle (talk to 6+ people / everyone).
- **Do:** learners turn each prompt into a correct question (*Do you live near here? / Are you a morning person?*).
- **When someone says yes:** write their name and ask **one follow-up question**. One name per row.
- **Baseline snapshot:** the teacher (or a second volunteer) uses the checklist: Can they ask a *do* question? Answer in a full sentence? Give 1 extra detail?
- **Later:** formal 2-minute baseline interviews in Weeks 2–3 (about 5 learners per week).
- **If behind:** learners talk to 4 people.

Step 7 · 7:10–7:15 · Exit Ticket + Homework · 5 min · NEVER SKIP

- **Exit ticket:** write one *be* question and one *do* question.
- **Homework:** explain it from the workbook and do item 1 together.

If time · 7:15–7:30 · pick in this order

- ① **Pronunciation (5 min):** Yes/No questions go **up ↗**; Wh- questions go **down ↘**. Hum the melody, then say the words. Pairs: A says a question, B draws the arrow in the air.
- ② **Question Scramble (5 min):** each pair builds 4 questions from an envelope of word cards.
- ③ **Interview and Introduce (10 min):** partners interview each other, then introduce the partner to a group: "This is Marta. She's from Guatemala." (Previews Lesson 2's *-s*. Don't teach it yet.)

Listening script: `L1_listening.mp3` (about 1:10; the conversation plays once, so play the audio again if needed)

> **Audio:** play from a phone + small speaker. No speaker? Read the script with a volunteer learner.

> **Narrator:** Lesson one. Listening. Rosa and Sam meet at the community center. Listen.
>
> **Rosa:** Hi! Are you new here?
>
> **Sam:** Yes, I am. I'm Sam. Nice to meet you.
>
> **Rosa:** Nice to meet you too. I'm Rosa. Where are you from, Sam?
>
> **Sam:** I'm from Honduras. And you?
>
> **Rosa:** I'm from Colombia. Where do you live?
>
> **Sam:** I live on Pine Street, near the park.
>
> **Rosa:** Oh, me too! Do you work near here?
>
> **Sam:** Yes, I do. I work at a hotel. I'm a cook. What do you do?
>
> **Rosa:** I work at a bakery. I start very early, at five in the morning!
>
> **Sam:** Wow. Do you have kids?
>
> **Rosa:** Yes, I do. I have two daughters. Are you married?
>
> **Sam:** No, I'm not. But my brother lives here with me.
>
> **Rosa:** That's nice. Well, see you in class!
>
> **Sam:** See you!

Answer key

- *Task A:* 1 T, 2 F (Honduras), 3 T, 4 F (a hotel), 5 T.
- *Task B:* 1 a cook, 2 5:00, 3 brother.
- *Task C:* 1 are, 2 do, 3 Do, 4 Are.

Teacher notes

- **Privacy:** never ask about immigration status, money, or exact addresses. *Married/single* is optional; *Do you have family here?* is an alternative.
- **Mixed levels:** stronger learners add a follow-up question to every answer; newer learners use the question cards as a script.
- **Typical mistakes from Spanish speakers:** *I have 35 years* (Spanish uses "have" for age) and *Where you live?* (Spanish questions need no helper word). These are the two most common errors this week. Write the correct form on the board, and **point learners to the Spanish note** on their Grammar page. They can read it themselves; you don't need to explain it.

Lesson 2 · A Day in My Life (Week 2)

At a glance

Objectives: learners can…

- describe a daily routine with 10 or more routine verbs
- use *he/she* + *-s*, *doesn't*, *Does…?*
- use *always* … *never* in the correct position

Materials

- Student Page 2
- routine picture cards (1 set per group)
- info-gap sheets A/B
- frequency signs (ALWAYS … NEVER)
- slips of paper
- `L2_listening.mp3`
- **Prep time:** 25 min.

Key vocabulary (with pictures in the Student Workbook)

get up, take a shower, get dressed, have breakfast, take the bus, drive, start work, take a break, pick up the kids, cook dinner, do the dishes, go to bed; every day, on weekends, in the morning, at night.

Clock-time plan

Core = 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. Everything after 7:15 is optional ("If time").

Time	Step	Min	Grouping (15 / 7–8)	If running behind
6:00–6:10	**Opening Talk + Homework Check** (same partner): ask 3 questions (*Where do you live? Do you work? Are you from a big city?*), then ask each other your 5 homework questions	10	Pairs	Teacher collects the homework instead of reviewing it on the board
6:10–6:18	**New Words:** picture page + Picture Sequence	8	Groups of 4–5 / 2 groups	Teach the ★ words; skip mime-and-guess
6:18–6:30	**Listening** + "Say it"	12	Individuals → pairs	Skip the third play; do Task C together
6:30–6:45	**Grammar Q&A:** simple present + frequency, then a short Information Gap	15	Whole class, then pairs	Do the Q&A + mistakes table only; the Information Gap moves to "If time"
6:45–7:00	BREAK	15		
7:00–7:10	**Talk Time:** Frequency Line → "Our Week"	10	Line, then pairs	Do "Our Week" only
7:10–7:15	**Exit Ticket + Homework**	5		**Never skip**
7:15–7:30	***If time*** (in this order): ① Pronunciation: 3 sounds of *-s* (5) ② Information Gap, full version (5) ③ "Guess Who?" (10)	0–15		Optional

> **How to use this plan:** the **core** is 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. If you fall behind, use the right-hand column. Everything after 7:15 is optional.

Step by step

Step 1 · 6:00–6:10 · Opening Talk + Homework Check · 10 min

- **Grouping:** pairs (same partner for both parts).
- **Minutes 0–5:** ask 3 questions: *Where do you live? Do you work? Are you from a big city?* Late arrivals join a pair.
- **Minutes 5–10:** partners ask each other their 5 homework questions.
- **Teacher:** walk around; write **only 2** corrected questions on the board.
- **If behind:** collect the homework; return it next week with one correction each.

Step 2 · 6:10–6:18 · New Words · 8 min

- **Grouping:** groups of 4–5 (15) / 2 groups (7–8).
- **Do:** New Words page: point, say, repeat twice.
- **Picture Sequence:** groups put 12 routine cards in order for a typical day and say each one aloud.
- **If time:** pairs play mime-and-guess.
- **If behind:** teach the ★ words only.

Step 3 · 6:18–6:30 · Listening + "Say it" · 12 min

- **Grouping:** individuals → pairs.
- **Before you listen:** "Marco looks tired. Why?"
- **Listen 1 → Task A** (circle the times). **Listen 2 → Task B** (Marco or his wife?). **Listen 3 → Task C** (fill in).
- **Ask:** "Why *drives* with an *-s*?" (his wife = *she*)
- **"Say it" (1–2 min):** the class repeats "My wife drive**s**. She work**s** at a restaurant." Make the -s loud.
- **If behind:** skip the third play.

Step 4 · 6:30–6:45 · Grammar: simple present + frequency · 15 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then pairs.
- **Say:** "We use the simple present for **routines and facts**. With **he, she, it**, the verb gets an **-s**. With *does / doesn't*, the -s moves to *does*, so the main verb has **no -s**."
- **Grammar Box:** read across one row of the question side, then the answer side. Learners choose a word from each column.
- **Q&A:** learner reads Q → class guesses → read A → board example.
- **Check questions:** "*Marco takes the bus.* One day or every day?" • "She ___ (not drive)." • "*I take usually* or *I usually take*?"
- **Short Information Gap (last 5 min):** A has Rosa's week, B has Ali's. Ask 3 questions each (*What time does Rosa start work?*). Don't show papers.
- **If behind:** skip the Information Gap.

Break · 6:45–7:00 · 15 min

- Put the ALWAYS … NEVER signs on the wall during the break.

Step 5 · 7:00–7:10 · Talk Time: Frequency Line → Our Week · 10 min

- **Frequency Line (4 min):** signs from ALWAYS to NEVER along a wall. Call "How often do you cook?" Learners stand at a sign and tell a neighbor.
- **Our Week (6 min):** pairs find 2 things in common and 2 differences, then report: "We both take the bus. Maria usually cooks, but I never cook!"
- **If behind:** do "Our Week" only.

Step 6 · 7:10–7:15 · Exit Ticket + Homework · 5 min · NEVER SKIP

- **Exit ticket:** one sentence about a family member with *-s*.
- **Homework:** explain it and do item 1 together.

If time · 7:15–7:30 · pick in this order

- ① **Pronunciation (5 min):** /s/ *works*, *takes*; /z/ *plays*, *drives*; /ɪz/ *watches*, *fixes*. Hold up 1, 2, or 3 fingers. **Most important: say the -s at all.**
- ② **Information Gap, full version (5 min):** finish all the blank cells.
- ③ **Guess Who? (10 min):** each learner writes 3 routine sentences anonymously. Groups read a slip aloud as *he/she* ("This person always gets up at 4…") and guess who wrote it.

Listening script: `L2_listening.mp3` (about 0:58; the conversation plays once, so play the audio again if needed)

> **Audio:** play from a phone + small speaker. No speaker? Read the script with a volunteer learner.

> **Narrator:** Lesson two. Listening. Ana and Marco talk at work. Listen.
>
> **Ana:** Marco, you look tired!
>
> **Marco:** I am! I get up at five thirty every day.
>
> **Ana:** Five thirty? Why?
>
> **Marco:** I work at the hospital. I start work at seven. I usually take the bus.
>
> **Ana:** Do you drive?
>
> **Marco:** No, I don't. My wife drives. She has the car.
>
> **Ana:** Does she work at the hospital too?
>
> **Marco:** No, she doesn't. She works at a restaurant. She works at night.
>
> **Ana:** So who picks up the kids?
>
> **Marco:** I do. I always pick them up at three thirty. Then I cook dinner.
>
> **Ana:** Do you ever rest?
>
> **Marco:** Sometimes! On Sundays, I never get up early. I sleep until nine!

Answer key

- *Task A:* 5:30; 7:00; 3:30; 9:00.
- *Task B:* works at the hospital = Marco; drives = wife; works at night = wife; picks up the kids = Marco; cooks dinner = Marco.
- *Task C:* drives; works; always; never.

Teacher notes

- Some learners work night shifts. Accept any routine: "morning" means whenever they wake up.
- Repeat the "one -s rule" every time the error appears this week.
- **Info-gap sheets:** make two copies of a weekly table and blank out 6 different cells on each.

Lesson 3 · Free Time (Week 3)

At a glance

Objectives: learners can...

- say likes and dislikes with *love / like / don't mind / don't like / hate* + noun or *-ing*
- agree and disagree (*Me too / Me neither / Really? I don't / Oh, I do!*)
- keep a short conversation going with *What kind of...?*

Materials

- Student Page 3
- four corner signs (LOVE / LIKE / DON'T MIND / HATE)
- free-time picture cards
- a soft ball
- "Find Your Twin" survey
- `L3_listening.mp3`
- **Prep time:** 15 min.

Key vocabulary (with pictures in the Student Workbook)

soccer, *cooking*, *dancing*, *shopping*, *cleaning*, *gardening*, *fixing things*, *watching TV/movies*, *walking*, *reading*, *video calls*, *music (salsa*, *cumbia*, *pop*, *rock)*, *What kind of...?*.

Clock-time plan

Core = 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. Everything after 7:15 is optional ("If time").

Time	Step	Min	Grouping (15 / 7–8)	If running behind
6:00–6:10	**Opening Talk + Homework Check** (same partner): "What time do you usually get up? Does your family get up early?" Then read your 6 homework sentences; the partner raises a hand at each *-s*	10	Pairs	Teacher collects the homework
6:10–6:18	**New Words:** picture page + feelings scale with gestures	8	Pairs	Teach the ★ words; skip the picture sort
6:18–6:30	**Listening** + "Say it"	12	Individuals → pairs	Skip the third play; do Task C together
6:30–6:45	**Grammar Q&A:** *like* + *-ing*; *Me too / Me neither*, then a short Ball Toss	15	Whole class, then circle(s)	Do the Q&A + mistakes table only; Ball Toss moves to "If time"
6:45–7:00	BREAK	15		
7:00–7:10	**Talk Time:** Four Corners → Break-Room Small Talk	10	Corners, then pairs (7–8: 2 corners)	Do Break-Room Small Talk only
7:10–7:15	**Exit Ticket + Homework**	5		**Never skip**
7:15–7:30	***If time*** (in this order): ① Pronunciation: /ŋ/ + stress for feeling (5) ② Ball Toss round 2 (5) ③ Find Your Twin survey (10)	0–15		Optional

> **How to use this plan:** the **core** is 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. If you fall behind, use the right-hand column. Everything after 7:15 is optional.

Step by step

Step 1 · 6:00–6:10 · Opening Talk + Homework Check · 10 min

- **Grouping:** pairs (same partner for both parts).
- **Minutes 0–5:** "What time do you usually get up? Does your family get up early?"
- **Minutes 5–10:** each partner reads their 6 homework sentences; the listener raises a hand at every *-s*.
- **Teacher:** note 2 common errors for the board.
- **If behind:** collect the homework.

Step 2 · 6:10–6:18 · New Words · 8 min

- **Grouping:** pairs.
- **Do:** New Words page: point, say, repeat.
- **Feelings scale:** teach with gestures (❤️❤️ love → ✘ hate).
- **Picture sort:** pairs sort the free-time cards into "I like" and "I don't like."
- **If behind:** teach the ★ words; skip the sort.

Step 3 · 6:18–6:30 · Listening + "Say it" · 12 min

- **Grouping:** individuals → pairs.
- **Before you listen:** "What do you think Kim likes?"
- **Listen 1 → Task A** (✓/✗ chart). **Listen 2 → Task B** (circle the reply). **Listen 3 → Task C** (fill in).
- **"Say it" (1–2 min):** repeat "I **love** danc**ing**." and "Me **nei**ther!" with strong feeling.
- **If behind:** skip the third play.

Step 4 · 6:30–6:45 · Grammar: like + -ing; Me too / Me neither · 15 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then circle(s).
- **Say:** "After *like*, *love*, *hate*, *don't mind*, use a **thing** or an **activity**. To make an action an activity, add **-ing**."
- **Say:** "*Me too* answers a **positive** sentence. *Me neither* answers a **negative** sentence."
- **Grammar Box + Q&A:** learner reads Q → class guesses → read A → board example.
- **Check:** "I don't like snow." → (Me neither / Really? I do!)
- **Short Ball Toss (last 5 min):** the thrower says a true sentence; the catcher agrees or disagrees correctly, then makes a new sentence. (Two circles for 15; one for 7–8.)
- **If behind:** skip the Ball Toss.

Break · 6:45–7:00 · 15 min

- Put the four corner signs up (LOVE / LIKE / DON'T MIND / HATE).

Step 5 · 7:00–7:10 · Talk Time: Four Corners → Break-Room Small Talk · 10 min

- **Four Corners (5 min):** call out an activity; learners walk to a corner and tell the others why ("... because it's boring"). 7–8 learners: use 2 corners only (LIKE / DON'T LIKE).
- **Break-Room Small Talk (5 min):** "You're on a break with a new coworker. Find one thing you both like." Switch partners once.
- **If behind:** Small Talk only.

Step 6 · 7:10–7:15 · Exit Ticket + Homework · 5 min · NEVER SKIP

- **Exit ticket:** one *love / hate + -ing* sentence.
- **Homework:** explain it and do item 1 together.

If time · 7:15–7:30 · pick in this order

- ① **Pronunciation (5 min):** the /ŋ/ sound at the end of *-ing* (back of the tongue up, no hard "g"). Stress the feeling word: "I **LOVE** dancing."
- ② **Ball Toss round 2 (5 min):** the catcher also asks a follow-up question (*What kind of music do you like?*).
- ③ **Find Your Twin (10 min):** learners use the 8-item survey, mingle, ask *Do you like…?*, and find the classmate who matches on the most items.

Listening script: `L3_listening.mp3` (about 1:05; the conversation plays once, so play the audio again if needed)

> **Audio:** play from a phone + small speaker. No speaker? Read the script with a volunteer learner.

> **Narrator:** Lesson three. Listening. Kim and Carlos talk on a break at work. Listen.
>
> **Kim:** Carlos, what do you do on weekends?
>
> **Carlos:** I love playing soccer. I play every Saturday. Do you like soccer?
>
> **Kim:** Not really. I like watching it on TV, but I don't like playing.
>
> **Carlos:** What do you like doing?
>
> **Kim:** I love cooking. And I like dancing. I go dancing with my sister on Fridays.
>
> **Carlos:** Me too! I love dancing. What kind of music do you like?
>
> **Kim:** Salsa and cumbia. I don't like rock music.
>
> **Carlos:** Me neither. It's too loud! Do you like shopping?
>
> **Kim:** I don't mind it. But I hate cleaning the house!
>
> **Carlos:** Oh, I don't mind cleaning. I listen to music when I clean.
>
> **Kim:** Good idea!

Answer key

- *Task A:* playing soccer: Carlos ✓, Kim ✗ • watching soccer on TV: Kim ✓ • cooking: Kim ✓ • dancing: Kim ✓, Carlos ✓ • rock music: Kim ✗, Carlos ✗ • cleaning: Kim ✗ (hates), Carlos ✓ (doesn't mind).
- *Task B:* 1 Me too!, 2 Me neither.
- *Task C:* Fridays; Saturday; mind.

Teacher notes

- Use music genres and artists from learners' own cultures (keep the examples general).
- *I like to cook* is also correct. At this level we practice the **-ing** form so learners learn one pattern well.
- *because* comes up naturally in Four Corners. Model it but don't teach it formally.

Lesson 4 · Right Now (Week 4)

At a glance

Objectives: learners can...

- say what people are doing now (*am/is/are* + *-ing*)
- ask *What are you doing?*
- tell the difference between "now" (present continuous) and "every day" (simple present)
- review telling time

Materials

- Student Page 4
- 10 action pictures (or a busy street picture)
- "Now or Every Day?" sentence cards
- a toy or real phone for role plays
- clock face
- `L4_listening.mp3`
- **Prep time:** 20 min.

Key vocabulary (with pictures in the Student Workbook)

waiting (for the bus), cooking, working late, doing homework, watching TV, looking at, calling, coming, right now, today; What time is it? It's five forty-five.

Clock-time plan

Core = 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. Everything after 7:15 is optional ("If time").

Time	Step	Min	Grouping (15 / 7–8)	If running behind
6:00–6:10	**Opening Talk + Homework Check** (same group): "What do you love doing on weekends? What do you hate doing?" (answer *Me too / Me neither / Really?*). Then share 2 homework sentences; vote for the funniest	10	Groups of 3–4 / whole group	Skip the vote; teacher collects homework
6:10–6:18	**New Words:** picture page + Charades ("You're cooking!")	8	2 teams / 1 team	Teach the ★ words; 3 charades only
6:18–6:30	**Listening** + "Say it"	12	Individuals → pairs	Skip the third play; do Task C together
6:30–6:45	**Grammar Q&A:** present continuous; now vs. every day, then a short Picture Talk	15	Whole class, then pairs	Do the Q&A + mistakes table only; Picture Talk moves to "If time"
6:45–7:00	BREAK	15		
7:00–7:10	**Talk Time: Phone Call Role Play** ("What are you doing?")	10	Pairs back to back	One call each (no partner switch)
7:10–7:15	**Exit Ticket + Homework**	5		**Never skip**
7:15–7:30	***If time*** (in this order): ① Pronunciation: contractions + *fifteen / fifty* (5) ② Picture Talk (5) ③ "Now or Every Day?" card sort race (10)	0–15		Optional

How to use this plan: the **core** is 6:00–6:45 and 7:00–7:15. If you fall behind, use the right-hand column. Everything after 7:15 is optional.

Step by step

Step 1 · 6:00–6:10 · Opening Talk + Homework Check · 10 min

- **Grouping:** groups of 3–4 (15) / whole group (7–8). Same group for both parts.
- **Minutes 0–5:** "What do you love doing on weekends? What do you hate doing?" Answer with *Me too / Me neither / Really?*
- **Minutes 5–10:** each person shares 2 homework sentences about other people; the group votes for the funniest.
- **Teacher:** correct 2 sentences on the board.
- **If behind:** skip the vote.

Step 2 · 6:10–6:18 · New Words · 8 min

- **Grouping:** 2 teams (15) / 1 team (7–8).
- **Do:** New Words page: point, say, repeat.
- **Charades:** a learner mimes an action; the class says "You're cooking!"
- **If behind:** teach the ★ words and do 3 charades.

Step 3 · 6:18–6:30 · Listening + "Say it" · 12 min

- **Grouping:** individuals → pairs.
- **Before you listen:** show a picture of a woman at a bus stop on the phone: "Who is she calling? Why?"
- **Listen 1 → Task A** (circle). **Listen 2 → Task B** (true/false). **Listen 3 → Task C** (fill in).
- **Ask:** "Is Rosa waiting for the bus every day or right now?" (right now)
- **"Say it" (1–2 min):** repeat "I'**m** cook**ing** dinner. What **are** you do**ing**?"
- **If behind:** skip the third play.

Step 4 · 6:30–6:45 · Grammar: present continuous; now vs. every day · 15 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then pairs.
- **Say:** "For something happening **right now**, use ***am / is / are* + verb-ing**. For **every day / usually**, use the simple present."
- **Board:** a timeline with a dot labeled NOW (continuous) and X X X marks (every day).
- **Grammar Box + Q&A:** learner reads Q → class guesses → read A → board example.
- **Check:** "*I'm cooking*: now or every day?" • "*She works at night*: now or every day?" • "Is *I cooking* OK?" (No: *I'm cooking*.)
- **Short Picture Talk (last 5 min):** pairs describe a busy picture ("The man is waiting."); B points to the person.
- **If behind:** skip Picture Talk.

Break · 6:45–7:00 · 15 min

- Set chairs back to back for the phone calls during the break.

Step 5 · 7:00–7:10 · Talk Time: Phone Call Role Play · 10 min

- **Set-up:** pairs sit **back to back** (like a real phone call: no lip reading!).
- **Card A:** "You're at the bus stop. The bus is late." **Card B:** "You're at home cooking. Your kids are doing homework."
- **Frame:** *Hi, it's ___. What are you doing? / I'm ___. Where are you? / I'm ___.*
- **Then:** switch cards, then switch partners. (15: 7 pairs + a 3-person "conference call." 7–8: everyone does 3 calls.)
- **If behind:** one call each.

Step 6 · 7:10–7:15 · Exit Ticket + Homework · 5 min · NEVER SKIP

- **Exit ticket:** "What is your family doing right now?" (one sentence)
- **Homework:** explain it and do the first "photo in words" together.

If time · 7:15–7:30 · pick in this order

- ① **Pronunciation (5 min):** contractions *I'm*, *she's*, *they're* (short and fast). *fifteen* (fif-TEEN) vs. *fifty* (FIF-ty). Pairs: A says a time, B points to it on the clock.
- ② **Picture Talk (5 min)** if it was skipped.
- ③ **"Now or Every Day?" card sort (10 min):** teams sort cards into NOW (*He's sleeping right now*) and EVERY DAY (*He sleeps at 10*), then fix 3 wrong cards (*She cooking now → She's cooking now*).

Listening script: `L4_listening.mp3` (about 1:06; the conversation plays once, so play the audio again if needed)

> **Audio:** play from a phone + small speaker. No speaker? Read the script with a volunteer learner.

> **Narrator:** Lesson four. Listening. Rosa calls Sam on the phone. Listen.
>
> **Sam:** Hello?
>
> **Rosa:** Hi, Sam! It's Rosa. Are you busy?
>
> **Sam:** A little. I'm cooking dinner. What are you doing?
>
> **Rosa:** I'm waiting for the bus. It's late again!
>
> **Sam:** Oh no. What time is it?
>
> **Rosa:** It's five forty-five. Class starts at six.
>
> **Sam:** Where are your daughters?
>
> **Rosa:** They're at home. They're doing their homework. My husband is working late today.
>
> **Sam:** Are you coming to class tonight?
>
> **Rosa:** Yes, I am! That's why I'm calling. Do you have the homework page?
>
> **Sam:** Yes. I'm looking at it right now.
>
> **Rosa:** Great! Can you bring it, please?
>
> **Sam:** Sure, no problem.
>
> **Rosa:** Oh! The bus is coming now. See you at six!
>
> **Sam:** See you!

Answer key

- *Task A:* 1 cooking, 2 at the bus stop, 3 5:45.
- *Task B:* 1 T, 2 F (he's working late), 3 T, 4 F (he has it / he's looking at it).
- *Task C:* cooking; are; doing; is.

Teacher notes

- Rosa and Sam are the same characters as in Lesson 1. Point this out; learners enjoy following them.
- **Typical mistake from Spanish speakers:** dropping *am/is/are* (*I cooking*), because Spanish often uses one verb word for "now." Point to the *'m* every time, and **point learners to the Spanish note** on their Grammar page.
- "Stative" verbs (*like*, *know*, *want*) usually don't take *-ing*. Don't teach this rule now. If someone says *I'm liking it*, just recast it: "Oh, you like it!"

PART C

Student Workbook

Lessons 1–4

New Words · Listening · Grammar · Homework

How to Use This Workbook

- Each lesson has **4 pages**: New Words, Listening, Grammar, and Homework.
- **New Words:** look at the pictures. Say the words. ★ = most important.
- **Listening:** listen to the audio 2 or 3 times. Check, circle, or write.
- **Grammar:** read across the box. Choose one word from each column.
- **Homework:** do it at home. Bring it to the next class!

> **Nota para hispanohablantes:** Cada lección tiene notas en español para ayudarte. ¡Pero habla inglés en clase!

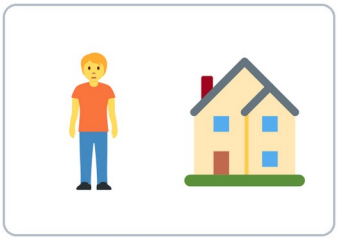
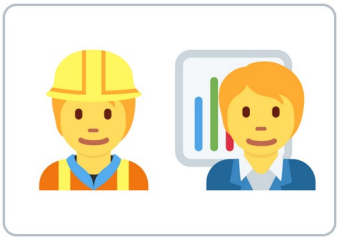
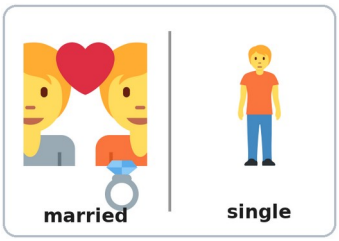
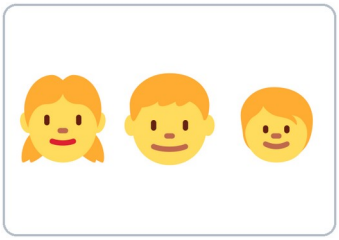
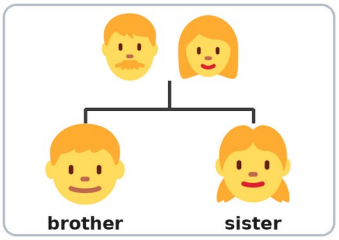
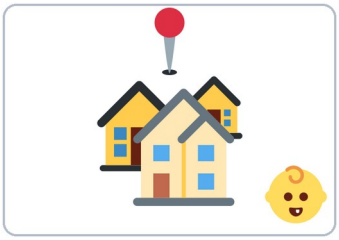
Lesson 1 · Nice to Meet You

Student Page 1 · Week 1

Name: _____ Date: _____

New Words

Look. Listen. Repeat. ★ = most important words.

 ★ **from**	 ★ **live (I live on...)**	 ★ **work**
 ★ **job**	 **neighborhood**	 ★ **married / single**
 ★ **kids (children)**	 **brother / sister**	 **hometown**
 **near**	 ★ **Nice to meet you**	 ★ **What about you?**

Lesson 1 · Listening

Listen to Rosa and Sam.

A. Listen. Check ✓ True or False.

	True	False
1. Sam is new.	☐	☐
2. Sam is from Colombia.	☐	☐
3. Rosa lives on Pine Street.	☐	☐
4. Sam works at a bakery.	☐	☐
5. Rosa has two daughters.	☐	☐

B. Listen again. Circle the answer.

1. Sam is a **cook / driver / teacher**.
2. Rosa starts work at **5:00 / 7:00 / 9:00**.
3. Sam lives with his **wife / brother / sister**.

C. Listen again. Write *are* or *do*.

1. Where _____ you from?
2. Where _____ you live?
3. _____ you work near here?
4. _____ you married?

Lesson 1 · Grammar

Grammar Box 1: Questions with *be* (am / is / are)

Choose one word from each column. Read across.

QUESTION		
Are	you	from Mexico? married? new here?
Is	he she	a cook? from Peru? married?

ANSWER		
Yes,	I	**am**.
No,	I'm	**not**.
Yes,	he she	**is**.
No,	he she	**isn't**.

Grammar Box 2: Questions with *do / does*

QUESTION		
Do	you	live here? work near here? have kids?
Does	he she	live here? work at night? have kids?

ANSWER		
Yes,	I	**do**.
No,	I	**don't**.
Yes,	he she	**does**.
No,	he she	**doesn't**.

Grammar Box 3: *Wh-* questions

QUESTION			
Where	**are**	you	from?
Where	**do**	you	live?
Where	**do**	you	work?
What	**do**	you	do?

ANSWER		
I'm	from	Honduras. Colombia. Mexico.
I	live	on Pine Street. near the park.
I	work	at a hotel. at a bakery.
I'm	a	cook. driver. teacher.

Questions and answers

Q: How do I make a question in English?

A: Put a **helper word at the front**: *am / is / are* or *do / does*.

Q: When do I use *am / is / are*?

A: With **where you're from, age, job title, feelings, married/single, and places**. Look at Box 1.

Q: When do I use *do / does*?

A: With **action verbs** like *live*, *work*, *have*, *like*, *speak*. Look at Box 2.

Q: What order do the words go in?

A: **Question word → helper → person → the rest.** Look at Box 3.

Q: How do I give a short answer?

A: Use the **same helper** as the question. *Are you…?* → *Yes, I **am**. Do you…?* → *Yes, I **do**.*

Q: Can I use *do* and *are* together?

A: **No, never.** ✗ *Do you are married?* ✓ *Are you married?*

Q: How do I say my age?

A: With *be*: *I'**m** 35.* (not *I have 35 years*)

Common mistakes

✗ Don't say	✓ Say
Where you are from?	Where **are you** from?
Where you live?	Where **do** you live?
Do you are married?	**Are** you married?
I have 35 years.	I'**m** 35.
Is from Peru.	**She's** from Peru.
Yes, I live.	Yes, I **do**.

Nota para hispanohablantes: En español decimos «¿Dónde vives?» sin palabra extra. En inglés la pregunta necesita **do/does** o **am/is/are** al principio: *Where **do** you live?* La edad usa **be**: *I'm 35* (no «I have 35 years»). Y siempre usa la persona: *She's from Peru* (no «Is from Peru»).

Tip for speakers of other languages: If your language makes questions with only your voice, or puts the question word at the end, remember: English needs a helper word (*do / are*) at the **beginning**.

Lesson 1 · Homework

Homework (10 minutes). Bring it next week!

1. Write **5 questions** for a friend, family member, or coworker: 3 with *do/does* and 2 with *am/is/are*.
2. Write their answers (in English!).
3. *Bonus:* Ask one person your questions in English.

My homework

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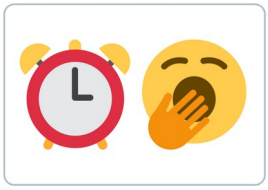
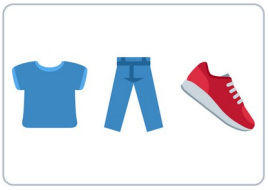
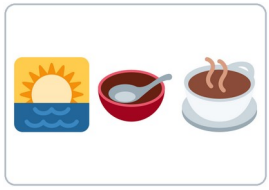
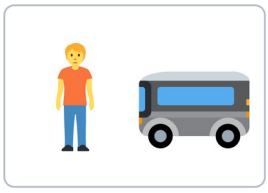
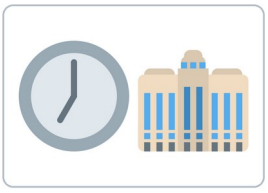
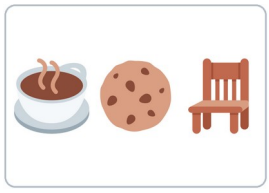
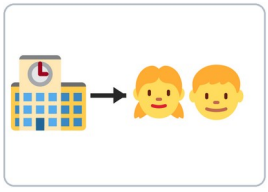
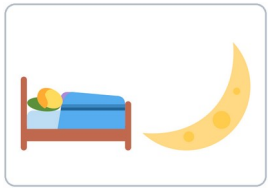
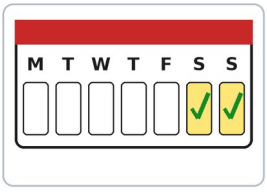
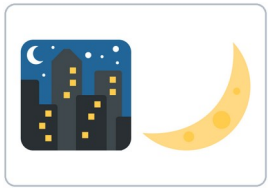
Lesson 2 · A Day in My Life

Student Page 2 · Week 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

New Words

Look. Listen. Repeat. ★ = most important words.

 ★ get up	 ★ take a shower	 get dressed	 ★ have breakfast
 ★ take the bus	 drive	 ★ start work	 take a break
 pick up the kids	 ★ cook dinner	 do the dishes	 ★ go to bed
 ★ every day	 on weekends	 in the morning	 at night

Lesson 2 · Listening

Listen to Ana and Marco.

A. Listen. Circle the time.

1. Marco gets up at **5:30 / 6:30 / 7:00**.
2. He starts work at **6:00 / 7:00 / 8:00**.
3. He picks up the kids at **3:00 / 3:30 / 4:30**.
4. On Sundays he sleeps until **8:00 / 9:00 / 10:00**.

B. Listen again. Who does it? Check ✓.

	Marco	His wife
works at the hospital	☐	☐
drives	☐	☐
works at night	☐	☐
picks up the kids	☐	☐
cooks dinner	☐	☐

C. Listen again. Write the missing word.

1. My wife _____. She has the car.
2. She _____ at a restaurant.
3. I _____ pick them up at three thirty.
4. On Sundays, I _____ get up early.

Lesson 2 · Grammar

Grammar Box 1: Yes/No questions

Choose one word from each column. Read across.

QUESTION		
Do	you they	work? drive? cook?
Does	he she it	work? drive? cook?

ANSWER		
Yes,	I we they	**do**.
No,	I we they	**don't**.
Yes,	he she it	**does**.
No,	he she it	**doesn't**.

*Answer about yourself: Do **you** work? → Yes, **I** do.*

Grammar Box 2: *What time…?* and *How often…?*

QUESTION			
What time	**do**	you	get up? start work?
What time	**does**	he she	get up? start work?
How often	**do**	you	cook? drive?
How often	**does**	he she	cook? drive?

ANSWER		
I	get up start work	at 6:00. at 7:30.
He She	get**s** up start**s** work	at 6:00. at 7:30.
I	always sometimes never	cook. drive.
He She	always sometimes never	cook**s**. drive**s**.

Sentences: positive and negative

Person	✔ Positive	✘ Negative
I / You / We / They	I **work**.	I **don't work**.
He / She / It	She **works**.	She **doesn't work**.

Questions and answers

Q: When do I use the simple present?

A: For **routines and facts**: things that happen again and again. *I work at a hospital. I get up at 6.*

Q: When do I add *-s* to the verb?

A: **Only with *he*, *she*, *it*** (one other person or thing). *She work**s**. Marco take**s** the bus.*

Q: How do I spell the *-s*?

Rule	Examples
Most verbs: **+s**	work → works, play → plays
-sh, -ch, -s, -x, -o: **+es**	watch → watches, go → goes, do → does
consonant + y: **-ies**	study → studies
Special	have → **has**

Q: After *doesn't* or *does*, does the verb keep the *-s*?

A: **No.** The **"one -s" rule**: the -s moves to *does*. *She work**s**.* → *She does**n**'t work.* → *Does she work?*

Q: How do I say how often?

always 100%	usually	often	sometimes	rarely	never 0%
I **always** take the bus.			She **sometimes** cooks.		He **never** drives.

Q: Where do *always*, *usually*, *never*... go?

A: **Before** the main verb: *I **usually** take the bus.* But **after** *be*: *He **is always** late.* Longer phrases go at the **end**: *I cook **every day**.*

Common mistakes

✗ Don't say	✓ Say
She work at a store.	She work**s** at a store.
He doesn't works.	He doesn't **work**.
Does she works?	Does she **work**?
I go always to the park.	I **always go** to the park.
I am work at a restaurant.	I **work** at a restaurant.
He have two kids.	He **has** two kids.

> **Nota para hispanohablantes:** En español el verbo cambia con cada persona (*trabajo, trabajas, trabaja*). En inglés **solo cambia con he/she/it**: agrega **-s** (*she works*). ¡No olvides la

-s! Y no uses *am* con otro verbo: *I work* (no «I am work»).

Tip for speakers of other languages: If your language has no verb endings, make a habit: **he / she / it = -s**. Circle every -s in your homework.

Lesson 2 · Homework

Homework (10 minutes)

1. Write **6 sentences** about the routine of someone you know (*My sister gets up at 6. She always takes the bus…*). Use at least 3 frequency words.
2. Listen to the audio again at home (scan the QR code or use the link) and repeat Marco's lines.

My homework

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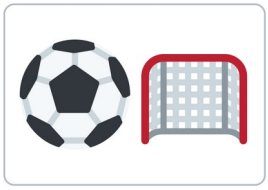
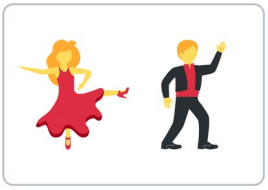
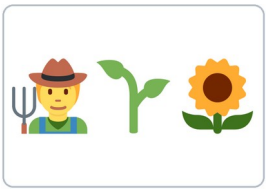
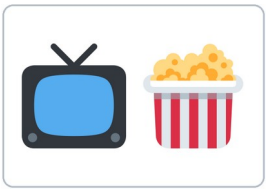
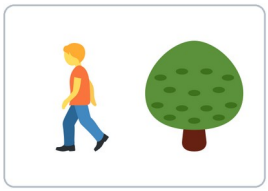
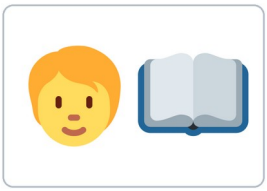
Lesson 3 · Free Time

Student Page 3 · Week 3

Name: _____ Date: _____

New Words

Look. Listen. Repeat. ★ = most important words.

 ★ **soccer**	 ★ **cooking**	 ★ **dancing**	 ★ **shopping**
 ★ **cleaning**	 **gardening**	 **fixing things**	 ★ **watching TV / movies**
 **walking**	 **reading**	 **video calls**	 ★ **music**
 ★ **What kind of (music)?**			

Music examples: salsa, cumbia, pop, rock (no pictures; ask learners for their favorite kinds).

Lesson 3 · Listening

Listen to Kim and Carlos.

A. Listen. ✓ = likes / doesn't mind, ✗ = doesn't like / hates. Some boxes stay empty.

	Kim	Carlos
playing soccer		
watching soccer on TV		
cooking		
dancing		
rock music		
cleaning		

B. Listen again. Circle the reply you hear.

1. Kim: "I like dancing." → Carlos: **Me too! / Me neither!**
2. Kim: "I don't like rock music." → Carlos: **Me too. / Me neither.**

C. Listen again. Write the missing word.

1. Kim goes dancing on _____.
2. Carlos plays soccer every _____.
3. Kim: "Shopping? I don't _____ it."

Lesson 3 · Grammar

Grammar Box 1: *Do you like...?*

Choose one word from each column. Read across.

QUESTION			
Do	you	like	soccer? cooking? dancing?
Does	he she	like	shopping? cleaning?

ANSWER	
Yes, I do.	I love it. I like it.
It's OK.	I don't mind it.
No, I don't.	I don't like it. I hate it.
Yes, he/she does.	He/She loves it.
No, he/she doesn't.	He/She hates it.

Grammar Box 2: *What...?* questions

QUESTION			
What	**do**	you	like doing? love doing? hate doing?
What kind of	music food movies	**do**	you like?

ANSWER		
I	like love hate don't mind	cooking. dancing. cleaning.
I like	salsa. cumbia. pop.	

Grammar Box 3: Agree or disagree

YOU SAY			YOUR PARTNER SAYS	
I	like love	coffee. dancing. soccer.	👍 **Me too!**	👎 **Really? I don't.**
I	don't like hate	coffee. dancing. soccer.	👍 **Me neither!**	👎 **Oh, I do!**

Questions and answers

Q: How strong are these words?

❤️❤️ love	❤️ like	😐 don't mind	👎 don't like	✘ hate

Q: What can I say after *like*, *love*, *hate*, *don't mind*?

A: A **thing** (*pizza*, *soccer*) **or** an **activity** (verb + **-ing**: *cooking*, *dancing*).

Q: Why do I add *-ing*?

A: *-ing* turns an action into an **activity**, like a "thing." (*I like **to cook*** is also correct, but in this class we practice **-ing**.)

Q: How do I spell the *-ing*?

Rule	Examples
Most verbs: **+ing**	cook → cooking, play → playing
Silent **e**: drop it	dance → dancing, make → making
Short verb (1 vowel + 1 consonant): double the last letter	swim → swimming, shop → shopping

Q: *Me too* or *Me neither*?

A: Look at your partner's sentence. **Positive** (*I like...*) → *Me too*. **Negative** (*I don't like...*) → *Me neither*. Look at Box 3.

Q: Where do *a lot* and *very much* go?

A: At the **end**: *I like soccer **a lot***.

Common mistakes

✗ Don't say	✓ Say
I like cook.	I like cook**ing**.
I am like pizza.	I like pizza.
I don't like coffee. / Me too.	… / **Me neither.**
She like dancing.	She like**s** dancing.
I like very much soccer.	I like soccer **a lot**.
I don't like nothing.	I don't like **anything**.

Nota para hispanohablantes: «Me gusta la música» → en inglés **la persona va primero**: ***I** like music*. Para actividades usa **-ing**: *I like cooking* (no «I like cook»). Usa **una sola** negación: *I don't like anything* (no «I don't like nothing»). *Me too* = «yo también»; *Me neither* = «yo tampoco».

Tip for speakers of other languages: an **-ing** word can be a "thing": *Cooking is fun. I love dancing*.

Lesson 3 · Homework

Homework (10–15 minutes)

1. Ask **3 people** (family, friends, coworkers): *What do you like doing? What do you hate doing?* If they don't speak English, ask in your language but **write in English**.
2. Write **6 sentences**: *My son loves playing video games. My wife hates cleaning…*

My homework

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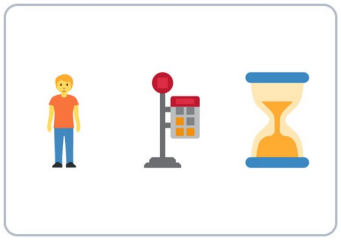
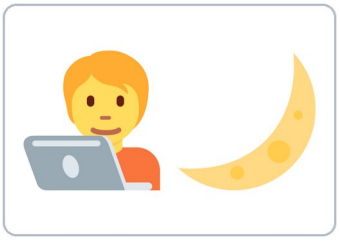
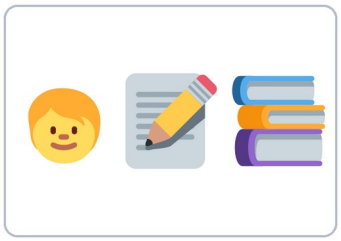
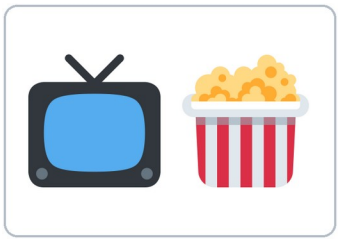
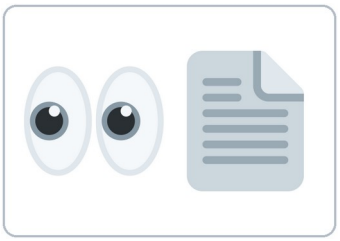
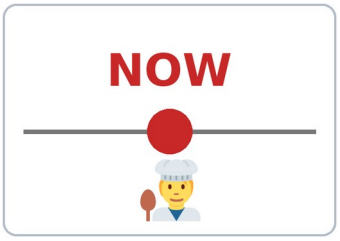
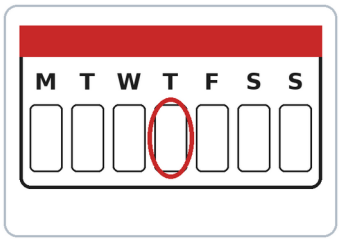
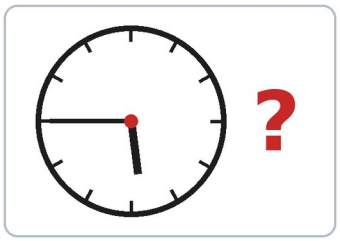
Lesson 4 · Right Now

Student Page 4 · Week 4

Name: _____ Date: _____

New Words

Look. Listen. Repeat. ★ = most important words.

 ★ **waiting (for the bus)**	 ★ **cooking (now)**	 ★ **working late**
 ★ **doing homework**	 ★ **watching TV**	 **looking at**
 ★ **calling (on the phone)**	 **coming (The bus is coming.)**	 ★ **right now**
 **today**	 ★ **What time is it? (It's 5:45.)**	

Lesson 4 · Listening

Listen to Rosa and Sam on the phone.

A. Listen. Circle the answer.

1. Sam is **cooking / sleeping / driving**.
2. Rosa is **at home / at the bus stop / at work**.
3. It's **5:15 / 5:45 / 6:15**.

B. Listen again. Check ✓ True or False.

	True	False
1. Rosa's daughters are doing their homework.	☐	☐
2. Rosa's husband is watching TV.	☐	☐
3. Rosa is coming to class tonight.	☐	☐
4. Sam doesn't have the homework page.	☐	☐

C. Listen again. Write the missing word.

1. I'm _____ dinner.
2. What _____ you doing?
3. They're _____ their homework.
4. The bus _____ coming now.

Lesson 4 · Grammar

Grammar Box 1: *What are you doing?*

Choose one word from each column. Read across.

QUESTION			
What	**are**	you	doing?
What	**is**	he she	doing?
What	**are**	they	doing?

ANSWER	
I**'m**	cooking. waiting for the bus. watching TV.
He**'s** She**'s**	working late. calling a friend.
They**'re**	doing homework. playing.

Grammar Box 2: Yes/No questions

QUESTION		
Are	you	coming? working today?
Is	he she	cooking? working late?
Are	they	sleeping? doing homework?

ANSWER		
Yes,	I	**am**.
No,	I'm	**not**.
Yes,	he she	**is**.
No,	he she	**isn't**.
Yes,	they	**are**.
No,	they	**aren't**.

Grammar Box 3: Telling time

QUESTION			ANSWER	
What time	**is**	it?	It's	five forty-five. six o'clock. seven fifteen.

Sentences: positive and negative

Person	✔ Positive	✘ Negative
I	I'**m** cook**ing**.	I'**m not** cooking.
He / She / It	She'**s** wait**ing**.	She **isn't** waiting.
You / We / They	They'**re** play**ing**.	They **aren't** playing.

Questions and answers

Q: How do I talk about something happening right now?

A: Use ***am / is / are*** **+ verb-ing**. *I'**m cooking**. She'**s waiting**.*

Q: Can I leave out *am / is / are*?

A: **No. ✗** *I cooking.* ✓ *I'**m** cooking.*

Q: What's the difference between *I cook* and *I'm cooking*?

A: ***I cook*** = every day, a routine. ***I'm cooking*** = right now.

RIGHT NOW: am/is/are + -ing	EVERY DAY: simple present
I'**m cooking** right now.	I **cook** every day.
She'**s working** late **today**.	She **works** at a hotel.
Words: *now*, *right now*, *today*, *at the moment*	Words: *every day*, *usually*, *always*, *on Mondays*

Q: Is *What do you do?* the same as *What are you doing?*

A: **No!** *What **do** you **do**?* = What's your job? *What **are** you **doing**?* = What are you doing right now?

Q: How do I spell the *-ing*?

A: The same rules as Lesson 3: *cook* → *cooking*, *make* → *making*, *shop* → *shopping*.

Common mistakes

✗ Don't say	✓ Say
I cooking now.	I'**m** cooking now.
She is work today.	She is work**ing** today.
What you are doing?	What **are you** doing?
I'm cooking every day.	I **cook** every day.

Nota para hispanohablantes: En español usamos el presente para «ahora» («¿Qué haces?»). En inglés, para **ahora mismo** usamos **am/is/are + -ing**: *What are you doing?* — *I'm cooking*. ¡No olvides *am/is/are*! (no «I cooking»). Cuidado: *What do you do?* = «¿En qué trabajas?», y *What are you doing?* = «¿Qué estás haciendo?»

Tip for speakers of other languages: If your language has no special "now" form, remember the formula: **am / is / are + verb-ing = happening now.**

Lesson 4 · Homework

Homework (10 minutes)

At **3 different times** this week, write what you and your family are doing:

It's 8:00 PM. I'm washing the dishes. My son is watching TV. My husband is working.

Bring your 3 "photos in words" next week. (Lesson 5's Opening Talk uses them!)

My homework

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Picture Credits

Vocabulary pictures use Twemoji graphics by Twitter, Inc. and other contributors (https://github.com/jdecked/twemoji), licensed under CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). The graphics were resized and combined, and arrows, calendars, clocks, and labels were added.

PART D

Reference

Audio · Copyright and licensing · Printing · Website · Questions · Sources

6. Listening Audio: Free AI Voices

6.1 What we needed

The voices had to be **completely free (no paid tier required)**, with a license that clearly allows classroom use, nonprofit or commercial use, and **redistribution** (posting MP3s on a website and sharing them with learners).

6.2 Comparison

Option	Cost	License / terms for our use	Quality and ease	Verdict
Chatterbox TTS by Resemble AI (open model, runs on a computer)	Free	**MIT License** for both the code (github.com/resemble-ai/chatterbox) and the model weights (huggingface.co/ResembleAI/chatterbox). Every file it makes carries an inaudible **Perth watermark** that marks the audio as AI-generated.	Very natural, expressive voices; runs on an ordinary computer without a GPU (about 5–8 minutes per lesson, including automatic checks).	✅ **Recommended** (used for the final audio)
Kokoro-82M (open model, runs on a computer)	Free	**Apache 2.0** weights. The model card says it "can be deployed anywhere," it is used in commercial products, and it was trained only on permissive or non-copyrighted audio. The runner we used (kokoro-onnx) is MIT-licensed.	Natural voices; about 20 US English voices; runs on an ordinary laptop or server without a GPU. Each 1.5-minute clip took a few seconds.	✅ Good free backup (used for the first drafts; listeners found it a little rushed and flat)
Piper TTS (open, runs on a computer)	Free	The code is open source, but **each voice has its own license**, listed in its MODEL_CARD. The *lessac* voices come from the Blizzard 2013 dataset, which **excludes commercial use**; the maintainer says users would need a separate agreement for redistribution rights. Some voices (for example *libritts_r*) use CC BY datasets that allow commercial use **with attribution**.	Good and very fast, but you must check every voice's license	⚠️ Usable only with carefully chosen voices

Option	Cost	License / terms for our use	Quality and ease	Verdict
Microsoft Edge "Read Aloud" / edge-tts	Free	edge-tts is an **unofficial** client for Edge's Read Aloud service. Microsoft has **not** published permission to redistribute the audio, and Microsoft Q&A answers point to the paid Azure Speech service for publishing.	Excellent voices	❌ Not recommended (rights unclear)
Google Cloud Text-to-Speech	Has a monthly free allowance (e.g., 4M characters for Standard/WaveNet, 1M for Neural2/Chirp 3 HD), **but billing must be enabled** with automatic charges past the free tier	Commercial output is allowed under Google Cloud terms	Excellent	❌ Fails the "no paid tier needed" rule (needs a credit card / billing account)
TTSMaker (website)	Free up to 20,000 characters per week	The site says audio can be used "for any lawful purpose, including commercial use," with no attribution required, but it "reserv[es] the right to make adjustments" to the free policy	Easy (no install); quality varies by voice	⚠️ Acceptable backup. Save a screenshot of the terms on the day you make the audio

> **Recommendation: Chatterbox TTS** (Resemble AI), run on this assistant's box (or any computer). It is truly free, its MIT license clearly permits redistribution, and no account is needed. **Credit line:** "Audio voices: Chatterbox TTS by Resemble AI (MIT License). These are synthetic voices, not real people; the files carry an inaudible Perth watermark that marks them as AI-generated." The output of a program takes the copyright status of its input (our scripts), not of the program (GNU FAQ).

6.3 What was produced (on this box)

File	Length	Speakers
`audio/L1_listening.mp3`	about 1:10	Narrator, Rosa, Sam
`audio/L2_listening.mp3`	about 0:58	Narrator, Ana, Marco
`audio/L3_listening.mp3`	about 1:05	Narrator, Kim, Carlos
`audio/L4_listening.mp3`	about 1:06	Narrator, Rosa, Sam

- Each file has a narrator intro, the conversation **once**, and an end cue. Play the audio again if needed (for example, once for each task). Lines are made one at a time, with clear pauses at commas, at the ends of sentences, and between speakers. Files are mono MP3 at 96 kbps, with even loudness.
- **Voices:** Chatterbox copies a voice from a short sample clip; the sample clips were made with Kokoro-82M (Apache 2.0). Each character keeps the same voice in every lesson.
- **Quality check:** we transcribed every file with an automatic speech recognizer and checked each line for missing or extra words and odd sounds; bad takes were remade. The transcripts match the scripts, except the recognizer spells "Ana" as "Anna" and "cumbia" as "kumbia."
- **To regenerate or make Lessons 5–13:** the scripts and the generator are in `audio/scripts.py` and `audio/processor.py` (see `audio/README.txt`).

7. Copyright, Trademark, and Licensing

> **Not legal advice.** This section summarizes public information from the U.S. Copyright Office, U.S. trademark records, and Creative Commons so the program can make informed decisions. For a definite answer, consult a qualified attorney (many areas have pro bono intellectual-property clinics for nonprofits).

7.1 The basic rules (with sources)

1. **Ideas and methods are free; expression is protected.** U.S. law says copyright never extends to "any idea, procedure, process, system, method of operation, concept, principle, or discovery" (17 U.S.C. § 102(b)). The Copyright Office's example: a book's text and illustrations are protected, but not the system the book explains. **For us:** teaching approaches (pair work, a pronunciation point every lesson, ending with a conversation, listening tasks) and standard grammar topics are free to use.
2. **Titles, names, and short phrases are not copyrightable** (Circular 33), **but they may be trademarks.**
3. **Layout and format are generally not protected,** but a creative **selection and arrangement** of specific content can be (Circular 33). **For us:** don't copy Intercambio's specific lesson-by-lesson list and order, page design, or exercises.
4. **Fair use** is case by case and weighs four factors: purpose (nonprofit educational helps), nature of the work, amount used, and **market effect**. Copying a commercially sold textbook for students tends to hurt its market, which weighs against fair use (U.S. Copyright Office Fair Use Index).
5. **Trademarks:** Intercambio's curriculum series name and "**THE INTERCAMBIO WAY**" are **registered U.S. trademarks** of Intercambio de Comunidades. Naming another product only to identify it ("nominative use") is generally allowed when you use no more of the mark than needed and **imply no sponsorship or endorsement** (*New Kids on the Block v. News America*, 9th Cir. 1992).
6. **AI-assisted materials:** the Copyright Office's January 2025 report says purely AI-generated material is not copyrightable. Human-authored expression, and creative human selection, arrangement, or modification of AI output, can be. **For us:** volunteers should substantially edit and adapt these drafts. The program's copyright (and license) then covers the human contributions.

7.2 What you CAN and CAN'T do with the real Intercambio books

✅ You can	❌ Avoid (without written permission from Intercambio)
Use your purchased books as intended in class	Photocopying or scanning pages for learners or posting them online
Read them to **compare coverage**: which grammar points and topics a level includes (facts and ideas)	Copying or **closely paraphrasing** their dialogues, explanations, exercises, instructions, or teacher tips
Use general teaching methods that many curricula share (pair work, pronunciation practice, a closing conversation, listening with check boxes)	Copying their images, page layouts, icons, or **audio**
Cover the same common ESL topics (food, health, transportation, bills), written in your own words and sequence	Reproducing their **lesson titles and lesson order** as your syllabus
Mention them factually: "independently developed; not affiliated with Intercambio"	Using Intercambio's series name, "The Intercambio Way," or "Intercambio" in your **name, logo, or marketing**, or saying "the improved Intercambio" or "Intercambio Level 2 version"
Tell teachers "if you also use Intercambio's books, Lesson 4 pairs well with their lessons on…" (factual cross-reference)	Feeding scanned pages into an AI tool and asking it to "rewrite" them: the result is likely a derivative of their text

> **Safe working process ("clean-room lite"):** One person checks the real books and writes **only a plain list of grammar points and topics** (no sentences copied). The writers create materials **from that list without the books open**. Keep dated drafts as a record of independent creation.

7.4 Licensing our own materials

License	What others may do	Good for	Watch out
CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 *(recommended)*	Share and adapt, with credit, **noncommercially**, and adaptations must use the same license	Free sharing with other volunteer programs while keeping commercial sellers out	"NonCommercial" depends on the **use**, not on whether the user is a nonprofit; a program charging tuition might be unsure whether it may use the materials
CC BY-SA 4.0	The same, but commercial use is also allowed	Maximum reuse (community colleges, fee-based programs)	Others could sell printed copies
All rights reserved	Nothing without permission	Full control	Makes sharing harder

- **Mark it like this** (footer of every page and on the website): "© 2026 [Program name]. Licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/). Audio voices: Chatterbox TTS by Resemble AI (MIT License; AI voices with an inaudible Perth watermark). Vocabulary pictures: Twemoji (CC BY 4.0), modified."

- **Pictures (new in Version 3):** the Twemoji parts of the vocabulary pictures stay under **CC BY 4.0**. CC BY material may be used inside a work you share under CC BY-NC-SA, as long as you keep the Twemoji attribution line (see the CC FAQ on combining licenses: https://creativecommons.org/faq/). Print the attribution line from Section 12 on the workbook credits page and in the website footer.
- **Your program name and logo are not covered** by the CC license. Add a line saying so (Creative Commons recommends this).
- **Ownership:** decide who owns the materials, the program or each volunteer author. A simple contributor agreement ("I license my contributions to [Program] under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0") avoids problems later.

8. Student Workbook: Printing and Distribution

Assumed workbook size: about 4 pages per lesson × 13 + midterm, final, and extras ≈ **64 black-and-white pages (8.5×11)**. All prices were found online in October 2026 and **change often; verify locally.**

Option	Cost per learner (64 pp.)	Upfront	Pros	Cons
Weekly handouts, self-service copier (~$0.10–0.15/side, reported by a third-party site; not verified)	~$6.40–9.60 if everyone gets every page; **less in practice** because you print only for who comes	$0	Easy to edit weekly; print only what's needed	Someone must copy every week
Weekly handouts, full-service copy shop (Staples lists black-and-white copies from about $0.32–0.34/side)	~$20–22	$0	No volunteer copying time	Expensive
+ Binder (1-inch economy binders, 12-packs: about $2.42 each at Walmart to $3.67–4.17 at Staples)	+$2.42–4.17		Pages stay organized; reusable	Bulky; adds cost
Amazon KDP author copies (8.5×11 = "large trim"; 24–110 black-ink pages = **$2.84 per copy**, plus shipping and tax)	**≈ $2.84 + shipping**	$0 (free account)	Cheapest bound book; perfect binding	Needs a finished, stable file. Author copies are sold at print cost; check whether the title must be published (public) on Amazon (not verified). Slower to update
Lulu "print copies for your own use" (private project) (a 100-page 8.5×11 black-and-white paperback was $5.48; the cheapest shipping cited was $5.69 per order)	**≈ $4–6 + shipping** (64 pages probably less; check Lulu's calculator)	$0	Can stay **private** (not in any store)	Higher print price than KDP
Free digital (PDF, Google Doc, website pages on phones)	$0	$0	Audio and links in one place; nothing to lose	Some learners lack data or printers; writing on paper still matters
Donated printing (host site, adult-education partner, public library, an employer partner)	$0–low	Ask	Saves money	Depends on goodwill; ask early
Grants: Dollar General Literacy Foundation adult literacy grants (nonprofits, libraries, schools within 15 miles of a Dollar General store; 2026 deadline was Feb 5, 2026; next cycle reported to open January 2027)	—	Application	Can fund workbooks and supplies (one recipient used its grant for ESL workbooks and handouts)	Competitive; annual timing

Recommendation:

This semester (pilot): print **weekly lesson packets** (3-hole punched) on a self-service or donated copier, **only**

for the expected attendance + 3 spares. Give each learner a **pocket folder or a cheap binder**, and post every page and MP3 on the website (with QR codes on each page). Expected cost: roughly **$9–14 per learner** in the worst case, and less as attendance drops. This lets you fix the materials each week while you pilot them, and you won't print 15 full books when 7–8 learners finish.

Next semesters (stable version): order a **bound workbook through a Lulu private project or KDP author copies (≈ $3–6 each + shipping)**. That's cheaper than full-service copies + binder (≈ $23–26) and about the same as self-service copies + binder. Apply for a literacy grant in January to cover it.

9. Website: Hosting the Curriculum and Audio

What the site needs: lesson pages (teacher + student), printable PDFs, 13+ MP3s (≈ 15–25 MB total), QR codes for each lesson, mobile-friendly, free, and editable later.

Host	Free plan facts (from the provider's docs)	Fit
GitHub Pages	Free; published site up to 1 GB; soft bandwidth limit of 100 GB/month; not for e-commerce or SaaS (an educational site is fine)	✅ **Recommended.** Our whole site is tiny. Content is versioned (every change is saved and can be undone)
Cloudflare Pages	Free; up to 20,000 files, 25 MiB max per file, 500 builds/month; unlimited bandwidth advertised	✅ Excellent alternative; supports drag-and-drop uploads without Git
Netlify (Free)	300 credits/month **hard limit** (about 15 GB bandwidth); projects **pause** until next month if exceeded	⚠️ Works, but the site could go offline mid-month
Google Sites	Free with a Google account; no coding; audio is embedded from Google Drive (some users report mobile playback quirks)	⚠️ Best if non-technical volunteers must edit pages themselves; less control over layout and printing

9.1 Who should build it: this assistant or a separate coding tool (Grok Build)?

Recommendation: have this assistant build it. It should be a simple static website built on this box and deployed to **GitHub Pages** (or Cloudflare Pages).

- **Why:** the lesson content, MP3s, and conversion scripts already live on this box. A static site (plain HTML + MP3 + PDF) needs no database or logins. The assistant can generate the pages directly from the same source files that make the Word document, keeping the site and the workbook in sync, and it can run quality checks (broken links, mobile view, audio playback) before publishing.
- **When Grok Build makes more sense:** Grok Build is xAI's terminal-based coding agent for working in a code repository. Choose it if you later want a real **web application** (teacher logins, learner progress tracking, quizzes that save scores) or if a volunteer developer will maintain the code on their own computer. That isn't needed for this stage.
- **What you would need to set up (about 15 minutes):**

1. Create a free **GitHub account** (ideally an organization account in the program's name).

2. **Connect GitHub** to this assistant (there is a GitHub connection option) and approve access to one repository.

3. Choose a site address, for example `yourprogram.github.io/level2`. Optionally, use your own domain name (bought separately).

4. Confirm the license footer text and the program name.

5. Decide: **public site** (simplest; fits a CC license) or private teacher pages (would need a different setup).

- **Alternative with zero accounts for the assistant:** the assistant builds the site as a ZIP file and you **drag and drop** it into Cloudflare Pages yourself.

11. Remaining Questions

From the real Intercambio books (please send short lists, not copied pages):

1. For each 2L/2R lesson, what **grammar point(s)** appear in the "Language Tools" box? (A one-line list per lesson is enough.)
2. What grammar does **Level 1** cover (especially *can/can't*, *there is/are*, simple past, describing people), so we don't re-teach or skip it?
3. What does **Level 3** start with, so Level 2 hands off smoothly?
4. What **format** do the "Review and progress check" lessons use (for example, listening + speaking + checklist)? A description only.
5. Does the teacher book assume a **class length**?

About the program:

6. Is the **midterm in Week 8** fixed, and do you need **grades** or just "Meets / Almost / Not yet"?
7. What are the **graduation requirements** (attendance %, final exam)? Are certificates provided?
8. Is there a **second volunteer** (helps with baseline and exam speaking tests)?
9. Classroom tech: is there a **speaker or projector**? Can learners use **phones** (WhatsApp group for audio links)?
10. **Printing:** what copier access do you have, and what's the budget per learner?
11. **Ownership and license:** who owns the materials (the program or the volunteer authors)? Is **CC BY-NC-SA 4.0** OK, or do you prefer CC BY-SA 4.0?
12. **Website:** may we create a public GitHub Pages site? What program name and address should it use?
13. **Name:** do you have a program or curriculum name? (We'll check it on USPTO before using it.)
14. **Voices:** are the Chatterbox voices acceptable? Would you like a slower version of any clip?

12. Sources

Intercambio research

- Issuu, Student Book 2L (cover and back-cover text): https://issuu.com/intercambio8/docs/2l_book_online_final
- Flatirons Library catalog, Level 2 Left Student Book (contents): https://broomfieldkids.flatironslibrary.org/GroupedWork/8e9b1684-554b-7dc3-f1f3-ee71db6f30d0
- Flatirons Library catalog, Level 2 Left Teacher Book: https://broomfieldkids.flatironslibrary.org/GroupedWork/a5ce394d-e16b-4431-d851-301e1af9161a
- Flatirons Library catalog, Level 2 Right Student Book: https://broomfieldkids.flatironslibrary.org/GroupedWork/5c23fb51-3b0a-a5fb-9bad-3b97bbd58531
- Los Angeles Public Library, curriculum page: https://www.lapl.org/literacy/curriculum
- Alaska Literacy Program, C&C resources: https://sites.google.com/alaskaliteracyprogram.org/alpteachers/curriculum/Intercambio

Vocabulary pictures (new in Version 3)

- Twemoji, maintained fork (graphics CC BY 4.0): https://github.com/jdecked/twemoji ; graphics license: https://github.com/jdecked/twemoji/blob/main/LICENSE-GRAPHICS ; attribution guidance in the README: https://github.com/jdecked/twemoji#attribution-requirements
- CC BY 4.0 deed: https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/
- File-by-file credits with source SVG URLs: `images/CREDITS.md`
- **Attribution line for the workbook and website:** "Vocabulary pictures use Twemoji graphics by Twitter, Inc. and other contributors (https://github.com/jdecked/twemoji), licensed under CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). The graphics were resized and combined, and arrows, calendars, clocks, and labels were added."

Text-to-speech

- Chatterbox TTS (MIT), code: https://github.com/resemble-ai/chatterbox ; model card: https://huggingface.co/ResembleAI/chatterbox
- Resemble Perth watermarker: https://github.com/resemble-ai/Perth
- Kokoro-82M model card (Apache 2.0, training data): https://huggingface.co/hexgrad/Kokoro-82M
- kokoro-onnx (MIT): https://github.com/thewh1teagle/kokoro-onnx
- Piper voice licensing discussion: https://huggingface.co/rhasspy/piper-voices/discussions/105 ; https://github.com/rhasspy/piper/discussions/271
- Lessac (Blizzard 2013) noncommercial license: https://www.cstr.ed.ac.uk/projects/blizzard/2013/lessac_blizzard2013_software/license.html

- edge-tts: https://github.com/rany2/edge-tts ; Microsoft Q&A on commercial use: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-in/answers/questions/6007729/commercial-use-of-microsoft-edge-text-to-speech-vi
- Google Cloud TTS pricing: https://cloud.google.com/text-to-speech/pricing
- TTSMaker terms (FAQ on homepage): https://ttsmaker.com/
- GNU GPL FAQ (program output): https://www.gnu.org/licenses/gpl-faq.html#GPLOutput

Copyright and trademark

- 17 U.S.C. § 102: https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/17/102
- U.S. Copyright Office, Circular 33 (Works Not Protected by Copyright): https://www.copyright.gov/circs/circ33.pdf
- U.S. Copyright Office, Fair Use Index: https://www.copyright.gov/fair-use/
- U.S. Copyright Office, AI Report Part 2 (Copyrightability): https://copyright.gov/ai/Copyright-and-Artificial-Intelligence-Part-2-Copyrightability-Report.pdf
- Trademark record, THE INTERCAMBIO WAY: https://trademark.justia.com/884/34/the-intercambio-88434242.html
- New Kids on the Block v. News America Publishing, 971 F.2d 302 (9th Cir. 1992): https://law.resource.org/pub/us/case/reporter/F2/971/971.F2d.302.90-56258.90-56219.html
- Creative Commons BY-NC-SA 4.0 deed: https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/ ; CC FAQ: https://creativecommons.org/faq/
- USPTO trademark search: https://tmsearch.uspto.gov

Workbook printing

- KDP paperback printing cost: https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G201834340 ; author copy cost: https://kdp.amazon.com/en_US/help/topic/G2MYNEKHT443C2H2
- Lulu cost comparison (blog): https://blog.lulu.com/print-on-demand-costs-for-authors/ ; Lulu private print projects: https://help.lulu.com/en/support/solutions/articles/64000255486-how-to-create-a-print-book
- Staples copies: https://www.staples.com/services/printing/offers/color-copies-and-printing/
- Binders: https://www.staples.com/bulk-binders/cat_CL167205/7y92m ; https://www.walmart.com/ip/Comix-Economy-1-inch-3-Ring-Binder-1-O-ring-250-Sheet-Capacity-School-Supplies-12-Pack-Black/5356564688
- Dollar General Literacy Foundation grants: https://www.dgliteracy.org/grant-programs/ ; Nebraska Library Commission notice: http://nlcblogs.nebraska.gov/nlcblog/2026/01/22/dollar-general-literacy-foundation-2026-grants-application-cycle-is-open/

Website hosting

- GitHub Pages limits: https://docs.github.com/en/pages/getting-started-with-github-pages/github-pages-limits

- Cloudflare Pages limits: https://developers.cloudflare.com/pages/platform/limits/
- Netlify credit-based plans: https://docs.netlify.com/manage/accounts-and-billing/billing/billing-for-credit-based-plans/credit-based-pricing-plans/
- Google Sites (add Drive files): https://support.google.com/sites/answer/90569?hl=en
- Grok Build: https://github.com/xai-org/grok-build